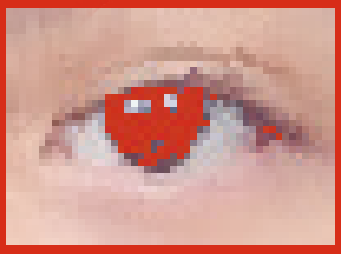
Portfolio













賴　　榆　　方

Yu　　Fang　　LAI

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瞻 ZHAN



瞻ZHAN

Immersive Live Performance

Stable Diffusion, Redream, TouchDesigner, Ableton Live

Size varies depending on the space

Artist

Wei-Cheng HSU

Cheng-Yun YEH

Yu-Fang LAI

Supervisor

Yi-Chun KO

Position

Sound Design

The title ‘Zhan’ means watching or looking forward in Chinese, which taken from the form and meaning of the ritual ‘Guān Luò Yīn.’

‘Guān Luò Yīn’ is an ancient ritual ledding by an experienced Taoist priest. During the ritual, participants are blindfolded with a black or red cloth. This practice aims to resolve issues that cannot be easily solved in the physical world, such as meeting departed loved one, witnessing one’s own destiny.

In Taiwan's tech culture, VR experience is often used to draw parallels with Guān Luò Yīn because both block the viewer's view, immersing them in alternate realities. Despite the similarities, there are three states prevailing VR hasn’t reached currently: the ‘Unreplicable Experience,’ the ‘Incomplete Spiritual Journey,’ and ‘Transcendence of Consciousness.’

Our project seeks to bridge this gap by conceptualizing a hybrid of VR and experimental performance. Through the fusion of VR, live performance, and real-time AI-generated images, endowing VR with these characteristics .

Employing AI as a spiritual entity, we provide superconscious imagery based on audience descriptions within VR headsets in real-time. The artists, akin to priests, act as intermediaries between believers and ethereal beings, building a co-creative environment involving viewers, actors, and AI. All aspects of creation, such as sound, vision and dialogue, are built in real-time operated by actors, aiming to create an individual differences environment to achieve the aforementioned three states.

We reexamine how VR can 'retrieve' the essence of Guān Luò Yīn, heralding its potential future in real-time and subconscious experiences during this work.

Demo Video

https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=svTuC1qKzyo

一個擁抱

The Only Thing I Can Do for You

賴榆方
Yu Fang, Lai
裝置作品

When you need comfort, how should I respond? After hesitating over the text box, I finally send, "I'll give you a hug."

Yet, our different backgrounds and experiences blur the sincerity— I can't fully feel the pain in your chest, and you can't see the thoughts on my back. When we remove the human element from a hug, can it become a purer form of comfort?



Standing within the installation, the audience feels a slight pressure, simulating the sensation of being hugged. In the interplay between inflation and deflation, the piece offers an artificial, non-human hug that is genuine and pure.







一個擁抱 The Only Thing I Can Do for You

Interactive Installation

Arduino, Blower, Self-Made Inflatable Structure
2 X 2 X 1.2(m)

Artist
Yu-Fang LAI

Supervisor
Tsun-Hung Tsai

Demo Video

https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=NTODF5fPy3I

Peering Through the Collapse



在塌縮的屍堆中探頭窺看







在塌縮的屍堆中探頭窺看
Peering Through the Collapse

Installation

Arduino, Plasma Ball, TouchDesigner, QRNG
1.1 X 0.7 X 1.4(m)

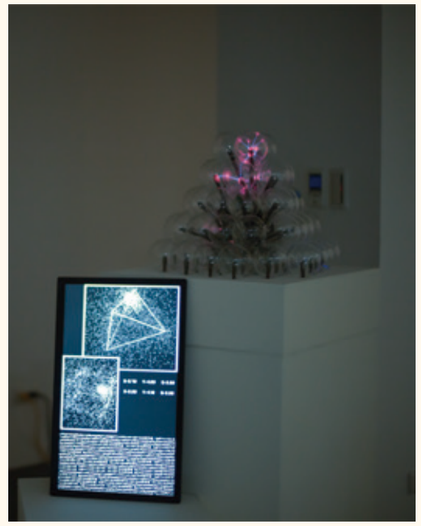
Artist
Wei-Cheng HSU
Yu-Fang LAI

Supervisor
CHENG-YU PAN

Position
Physical Form Production

Quantum physics tells us that everything we see, including ourselves, is made of quanta. However, in our everyday world, we are separated from quantum properties like superposition, entanglement, and randomness by a gap we cannot cross. Today, we use data to imagine and apply quantum states, but we cannot truly experience them. This work tries to bridge that gap by collecting real-time quantum random numbers generated on-site, using them to control the currents in a plasma ball, making randomness visible and tangible.

On the "B-side" of this work, these collapsed quantum states, stripped of their quantum characteristics, can, to some extent, be seen as "quantum corpses." We question: If creations are built upon these "corpses," can they truly be considered quantum art?



Demo Video

https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=JS4LMvRSoyc

keep working

Installation

Arduino, Discarded Metal Parts, Acrylic

50 X 20 X 60(cm)



The work consists of two parts. The lower horizontal plane features a multi-link mechanism, resembling a windshield wiper, that continuously sweeps the ground. Above it, a machine made of various parts drips black liquid, symbolizing the occurrence of both large and small events. Like a malfunctioning machine, these droplets fall into the sweeping area and are brushed aside. Despite its apparent flaws, the multi-link mechanism maintains its perpetual motion.

Artist

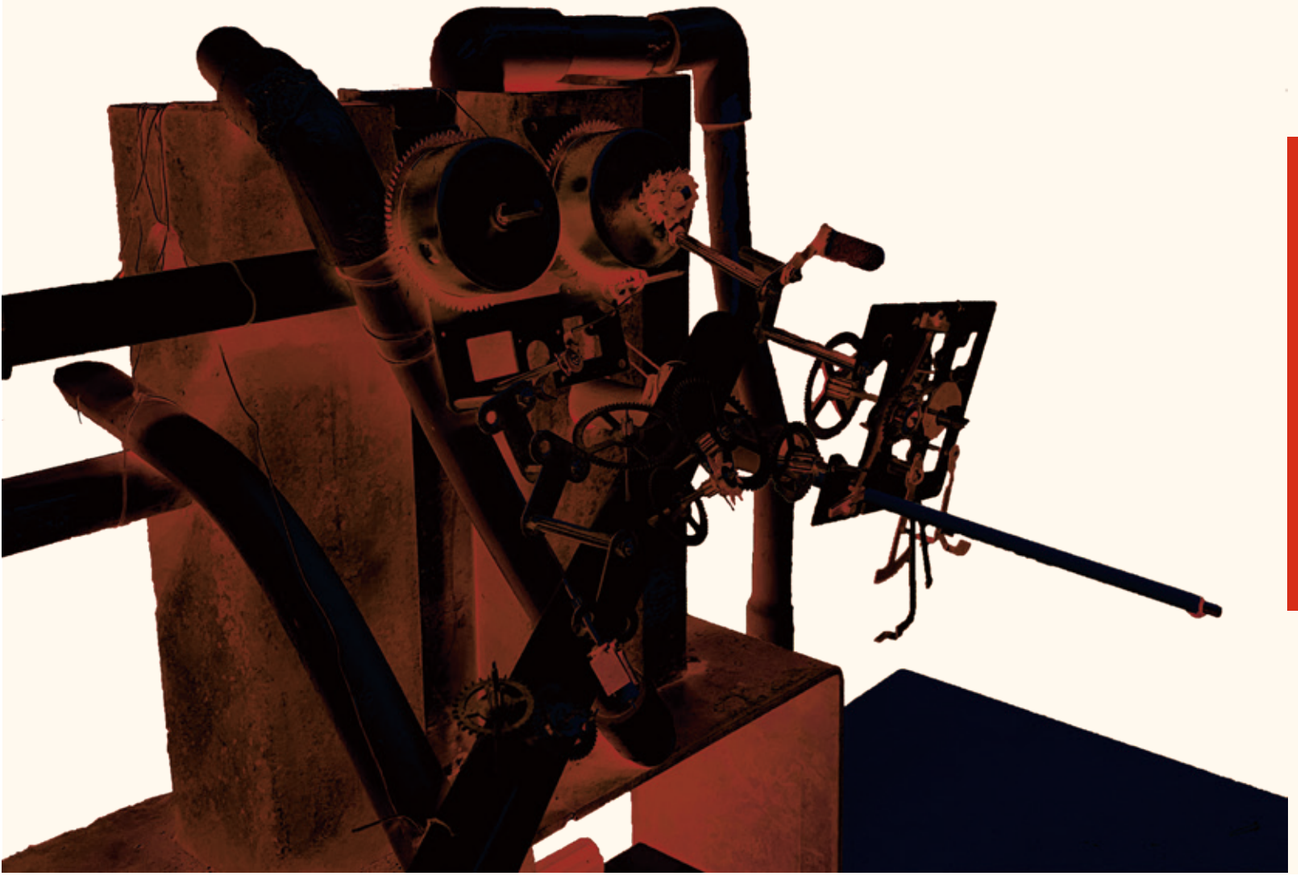
Deng-Kai ZHAN

Yu-Fang LAI

Position

Mechanism Design

Construction and Assembly



As children, we memorized sayings like "everyone is a screw," small yet indispensable. However, when major events occur and time passes, life continues, and the gears keep turning. This feeling mirrors the works of manga artist Tatsuki Fujimoto, where sudden plot explosions quickly return to the mundane, imparting a sense of powerlessness and reminding us that our existence is not eternal. We chose "cleaning" as the dynamic element of our work, connecting it to childhood memories of windshield wipers that left behind uncomfortable traces, evoking a profound sense of powerlessness.



軍紀歌

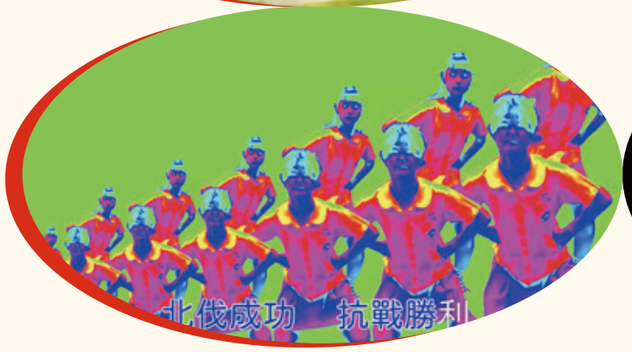














軍紀歌 Song of Military Discipline

Music Video

Artist

Han-Yun ZHUANG
Yan-Zhen LI
Cheng-Yun YEH
Min-Xuan HONG
Yu-Fang LAI

Position

Producer, Editor, Actor

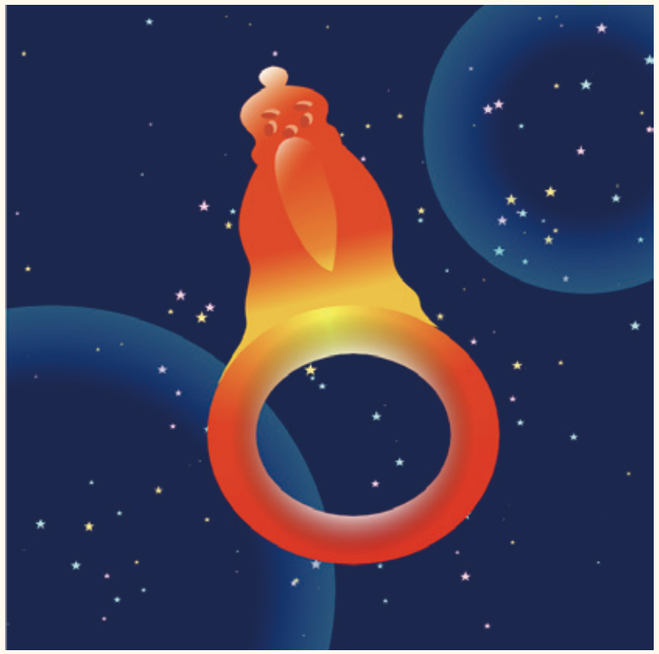
Video

https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=_2s1t9_OL4U

Using humorous visual language, 軍紀歌 questions and resists the age-based hierarchical system within the school environment. The illogical visual narrative intertwines past real-life experiences, accompanied by the highly submissive lyrics of military songs, forming our response to this unreasonable class structure.

紅線

Red Strings



月老 Matchmaker God

Generative Art

p5.js

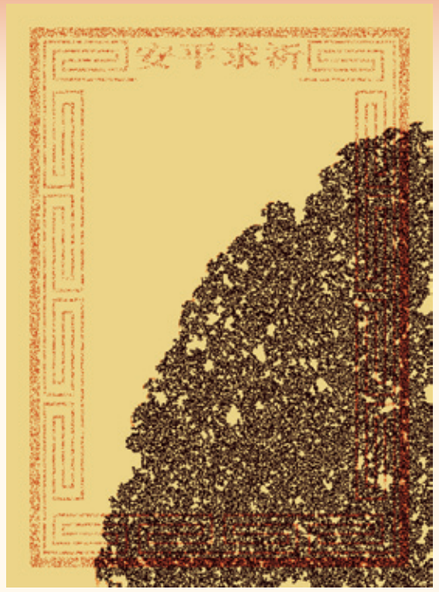
Artist

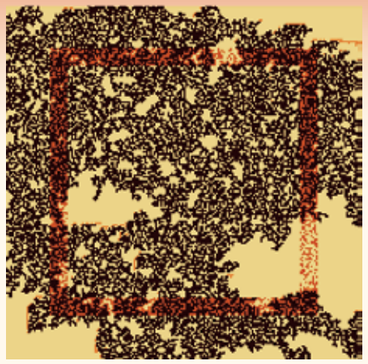
Yu-Fang LAI

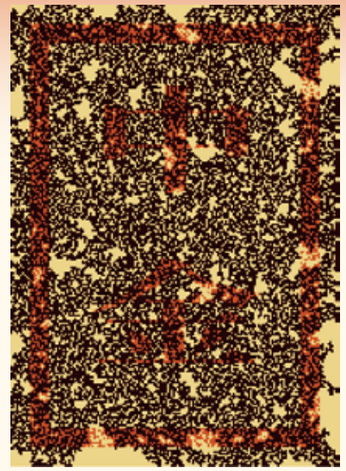
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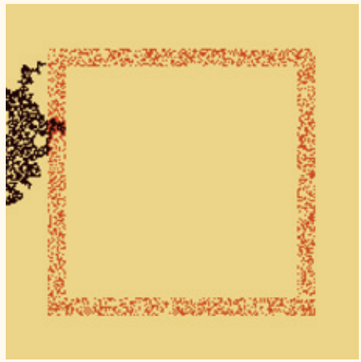
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We often visit temples dedicated to the Matchmaker God, seeking love and hoping for an easy way to form meaningful relationships. The Matchmaker God resembles a factory, endlessly producing red threads to connect destinies. Reflecting on this, we associated the idea of love with rings, and this led us to the childhood favorite—gummy candy rings. Inspired by these memories, this work took shape. For the background, we drew from the imagery of mass production, reminiscent of childhood moments spent watching *Sailor Moon*, grounding the concept in playful nostalgia.









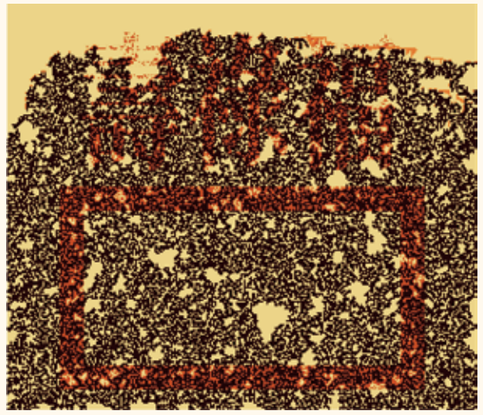
紙錢 Joss Paper

Generative Art

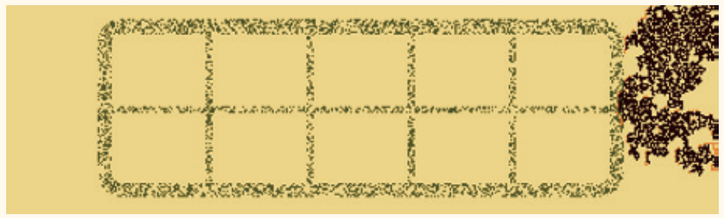
p5.js

Artist

Yu-Fang LAI



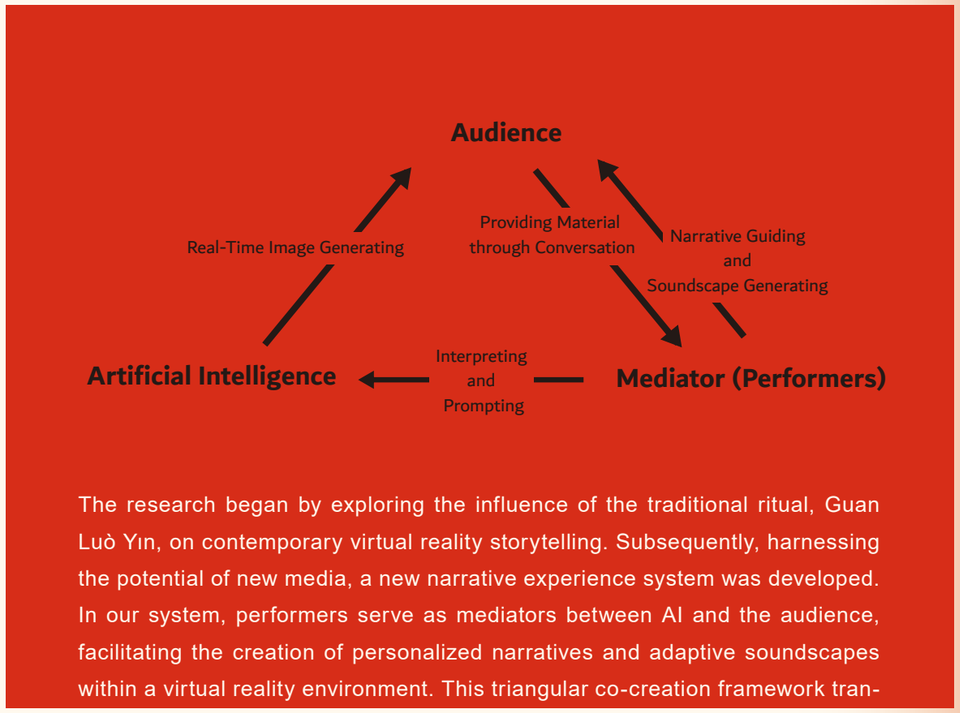
Joss paper serves as a connection between the mortal world and the afterlife. Through its burning, we attempt to communicate with the deceased and spirits, sending messages across realms. This piece features five forms of joss paper, burned in random patterns—some remain untouched, some partially burned, and some completely incinerated—emulating the authentic and unpredictable nature of burning joss paper.



p5.js

https://editor.p5js.org/baaaa/full/qJJjHK7Z2

Immersive Media Retrieving Spiritual Ritual: Co-constructed Narratives of Virtual Reality, Artificial Intelligence, and Theatrical Arts



The research began by exploring the influence of the traditional ritual, Guan Luò Yın, on contemporary virtual reality storytelling. Subsequently, harnessing the potential of new media, a new narrative experience system was developed. In our system, performers serve as mediators between AI and the audience, facilitating the creation of personalized narratives and adaptive soundscapes within a virtual reality environment. This triangular co-creation framework transcends the limitations of pre-written scripts, allowing for deeper explorations of inner realms and providing a more personalized storytelling experience. This project has been publicly performed in Taiwan and France over a dozen times. Future studies will concentrate on optimizing the real-time conversational narrative system and gathering extensive feedback to improve and validate its applicability and effectiveness across diverse artistic and cultural contexts.

Immersive Media Retrieving Spiritual Ritual: Co-constructed Narratives of Virtual Reality, Artificial Intelligence, and Theatrical Arts

Art Paper

Writer
Wei-Cheng HSU
Yi-Chun KO
Cheng-Yun YEH
Yu-Fang LAI

Live Presentation

https://www.youtube.com/live/QTShjxEE1_8?t=2800s



Online Proceeding

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https://zenodo.org/records/13382838



Immersive Media Retrieving Spiritual Ritual: Co-constructed Narratives of Virtual Reality, Artificial Intelligence, and Theatrical Arts

edited in 2024